Interestingly, Ahmad Wali Massoud (younger brother of Ahmad Shah Massoud) offers a counter-narrative. In his words, India gave

> some political and moral support and probably some humanitarian support as well. Because the support was not in any other kind or any other form at all. It was not in the form of military [supplies]. Although from time to time the Resistance forces were being accused by the Taliban or by the Pakistani circles that India was supporting the Resistance militarily or sending advisors or arms, but they are all baseless.[50]

Wali Massoud's statement, however, is a minority view even in Afghanistan. According to most interviews conducted with former Massoud supporters (most of whom are still close to the Massoud family or Abdullah Abdullah and Qanooni), India did play a role in the military sphere. Allegedly, Ahmad Shah Massoud secretly visited India in 2001 to seek military support few months before his assassination on 9 September 2001.[51]

The debate today is more over the 'nature' of military supplies India provided the UF, i.e. were they 'lethal' or 'non-lethal'? As early as 23 October 1996, the Taliban said they had 'information that the Indian Government, until the very end was providing political, economic and military assistance to Burhanuddin Rabbani's illegal and unrepresentative government in Kabul'.[52] According to the Taliban, India was the key air link for the Rabbani administration in Kabul and helped keeping Ariana Afghan Airlines afloat.[53] Used for flying military supplies when operating out of New Delhi, Indian technicians were employed at the Bagram Airbase to keep warplanes combat-ready. There is proof that as early as mid-May 1995, the Indian government did consider Rabbani's requests for training Afghan pilots in the civilian sector.[54] However, given the little civilian traffic going to Kabul because of the security situation in Afghanistan, one can question the purpose of training Afghan pilots. New Delhi also supplied military spares for the UF's Russian-made weaponry, alongside medical treatment for Rabbani's wounded soldiers.[55] Islamabad had been alleging that under the MEA's cover of humanitarian assistance, Rao was funneling material support to Rabbani. This included sending spare parts and technicians to fix Soviet weaponry to allow Rabbani and Massoud to continue their fight against Hekmatyar and later the Taliban. According to Pakistan's army and intelligence sources, groups of two or three Indian cargo planes landed on Afghan soil on 15, 16, 21, and 27 June 1995.